



Fig. 6: MK Aromatics does not need to segregate, wash or dry the plastics

on a conveyor belt that leads to a rotary drummer, where the dust and dirt get settled at the bottom and diverted to a compost pit. The dust-free plastics are collected, bailed and then fed into the loading press. The hydraulic cylinder in the press pushes the plastic into the reactor, which operates between 350°C and 450°C, where the plastic is melted and vaporised. The resulting vapour from the reactor is then condensed to get crude oil, which can be further distilled to get various derivatives of hydrocarbons. The non-condensable gases like methane, butane and propane are recycled back to the reactor and used as fuel for the reactor.

This method is eco-friendly and

energy-efficient as fuels are produced without any emissions and effluents. The fuels produced by MK Aromatics are used by well-known companies like Unilever and Britannia to energise their plants.

Conclusion

Companies mentioned above and some other companies, or individual innovators who are not mentioned, are creating a long-term promise by changing end-of-life plastics to valuable renewable fuels in a sustainable and environment-friendly way. The huge amount of money we have spent as half-measures on WTE plants is in a black hole now. The investments

and the efforts made by these plastic wastes-to-energy companies will substantiate the principle 'in for a penny in for a pound.'

Reliance Industries plans to become one of the world's leading new energy companies by creating value from plastic wastes that yields a clean, affordable energy and makes carbon-dioxide a recyclable resource. State governments, NGOs, investors, waste management practitioners and environmental conservation groups should recognise waste plastics as a resource for a clean renewable energy, and join hands with the plastic-to-fuel innovators to develop more pioneering technologies that produce ultra-clean emissions and replace fossil fuels.

With the support of the government, we expect that the conversion of waste plastics to energy in all states of India will show a sharp rise in the following years and thus promote our country's economy. By doing so, we are not only moving towards the circular economy but also bringing more benefits to the environment to create a win-win for all. **EFY**

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